

1949, April 8

The following is a faithful transcription of the typed original by the Servant of God, Father Solanus Casey, O.F.M. Cap.

April 8, 1949

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4/8/49.

Blessed be God!

Feast of St. Dominic.

Glory be to God !

Dear Joseph: God bless you and yours.

Having finished a card to Mrs. - your winnifred- last night, I want to get this off together with it before I forget and something be "sowed under.

I started to kinda started to moralize in my short card but it seemed to me after I was through that my effort was rather vague. At all events I'm giving it to the air this Morning and hope it contribute something to her encouragement. For, this side of Heaven who is there living that needs no encouragement now and then, at least. How, beyond all conception of creatures, how marvelously has not our divine Master Jesus provided such encouragement - with consolations against trials and difficulties undertaken, even when only partly and imperfectly for His dear sake, that, if only appreciated properly on our part, lend to our "lot otherwise in this vale of tears", - Ah! colors and hopes that surpass in reality even the joys of humanity before the Fall in Paradise.

O! If humanity could only appreciate, - if in studying appreciation and gratitude in the School of Jesus and Mary - what a taste of Heaven humanity would be given even in this earthly vestibule! Appreciation? Gratitude! Hence the little verse:

God made me to know Him ! O! What a bles'd aim!
To love Him and serve Him sure rests in the same.
It's Heaven-begun, for the grateful ON EARTH.
To treasure aright ! ? ! Highest Heaven its worth.

God Himself is the principal reward even here for each one of us inasmuch as we learn to appreciate; inasmuch as we put on Christian Gratitude. Glory be to God in the Highest! Bles't and prais'd be the Hearts of Jesus and Mary!